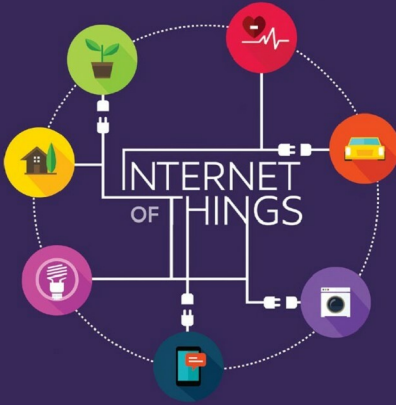


THE INTERNET OF THINGS



The IoT is a technology in the making and we can experience it in small ways, even now. The author presents an 'appetite whetting' article on it, highlighting its vast potential while also raising concerns about data security and privacy.

The Internet of Things is often referred to by other names—the Internet of ‘Everything’ or the Internet of Intelligent Objects. It is a network of objects that can communicate with each other. They could be in sensors, electronics or the software that is used to gather, exchange or analyse the data between various devices which is further used for management, planning and decision making. The IoT enables direct connection between physical devices and computer based systems. So this has led to an era in which the connection between devices or objects will be more than the one between human beings. The IoT concept is such that anything with intelligence fed into it, can be connected.

With the continuous evolution in technology, today, the communication between people is reducing while human beings are getting more connected to their devices.

Today, many organisations such as Cisco, GE, etc, are

using the IoT for developing their applications.

The importance of the IoT is continuously increasing due the growth of cloud computing, mobile technology and data analytics.

IoT will greatly impact human life. Consider a world in which, based on the time you set for your alarm to ring, the coffee maker will start preparing coffee and the geyser will begin to heat the water for your bath. Outside home, the car will automatically track how heavy traffic is and will apprise you of the situation. When the vegetables in the refrigerator run low, the fridge will re-order more, automatically, from the nearest store. This is what IoT technology is all about.

It includes various technologies that cover wireless sensor networks, RFID enabled tracking, embedded systems, Internet connected wearables, Bluetooth-enabled devices that connect to the Internet, etc.